🧰 AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Workshop

Utilities & Swiss-Army Tools

47	650,823	81%	34
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

Intro: The everyday carry — decoding, proxying, dissecting and transforming anything the job throws at you.

Deep-research edition. Every entry re-verified and enriched with live GitHub statistics (stars, first release, last push, license, language) pulled 2026-10-17 via the GitHub API, plus per-realm field intelligence. Tool profiles rank the realm's most-adopted projects and note who uses each tool and the commercial product it replaces; the full inventory keeps every curated entry.

Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — **444 curated free tools across 14 realms**.

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven
CC0 · 2026-10-17

01 Realm Intelligence

live GitHub census · 2026-10-17

47	38	650,823	34	9,111	2010
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Intro: The everyday carry — decoding, proxying, dissecting and transforming anything the job throws at you.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE (AI-ASSISTED)

The Workshop realm of cybersecurity utilities hosts 47 curated tools, with 81 percent (38) available on GitHub, dating back to its oldest entry in February 2010. Adoption is heavily concentrated in top-starred tools, with Ghidra, ImHex, jadx, x64dbg, and mitmproxy accounting for a combined 291,800 stars—roughly 45 percent of the realm's total 650,823 stars—while the median tool holds 9,111 stars. Maintenance activity shows 34 tools received code pushes in 2026, leaving 13 quiet classics including Voltron, boxxy, Brida, and Awesome Malware Analysis that have not seen recent updates. The license mix leans toward open permissive and copyleft terms, with GPL (12) and MIT (10) making up nearly half of all licenses, and the small set of tools written in Rust (3) signals a growing shift toward memory-safe systems programming for utility tools.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

01 The Adoption Map

who the community actually stars

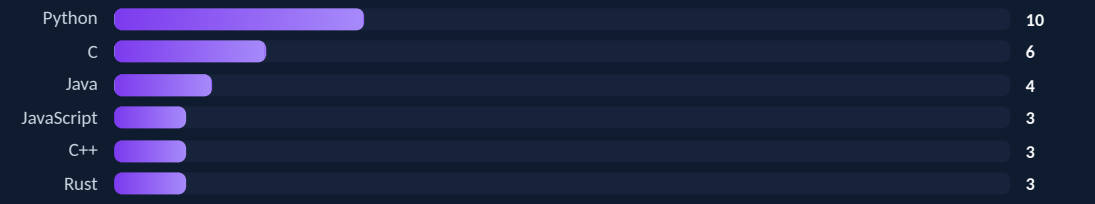
TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST-FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



LANGUAGE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



01 Generations & Momentum

the realm's age structure

THE FOUNDERS — OLDEST TRACKED ENTRIES

mitmproxy	2010-02-16
Netron	2010-12-26
Apktool	2012-03-19
radare2	2012-07-03
OpenSSL	2013-01-15

THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST GITHUB ARRIVALS

OCSF	2022-04
friTap	2021-09
dnSpyEx	2021-05
pyWhat	2021-03
Interactsh	2021-01

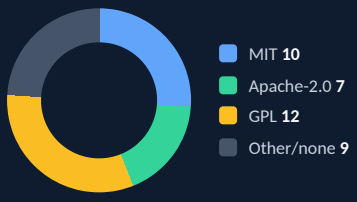
CREATION ERAS — WHEN THE REALM WAS BUILT

2008-2012	2013-2016	2017-2020	2021-2026
4	20	9	5

QUIET CLASSICS (NO 2026 PUSH, STILL THE STANDARD)

Voltron, boxxy, Brida, Awesome Malware Analysis

LICENSE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



02 Tool Profiles — the heavyweights

full-page dossiers · ranked by adoption

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, **who uses it and which commercial product it replaces**, and its star weight against the realm's #1.

Profiles are ordered by GitHub adoption (stars). Non-GitHub entries follow, alphabetically. Flagship marks the realm's top 8 by stars.

01 Ghidra

github.com/NationalSecurityAgency/ghidra

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 89.9k	GITHUB STARS
10,049	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2019	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Java	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Ghidra is a software reverse engineering (SRE) framework"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the NSA's open-source reverse-engineering suite; disassembly, decompilation and scripting for free.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by reverse engineers analyzing binaries of any architecture; the NSA's free suite that stands in for IDA Pro and Binary Ninja.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



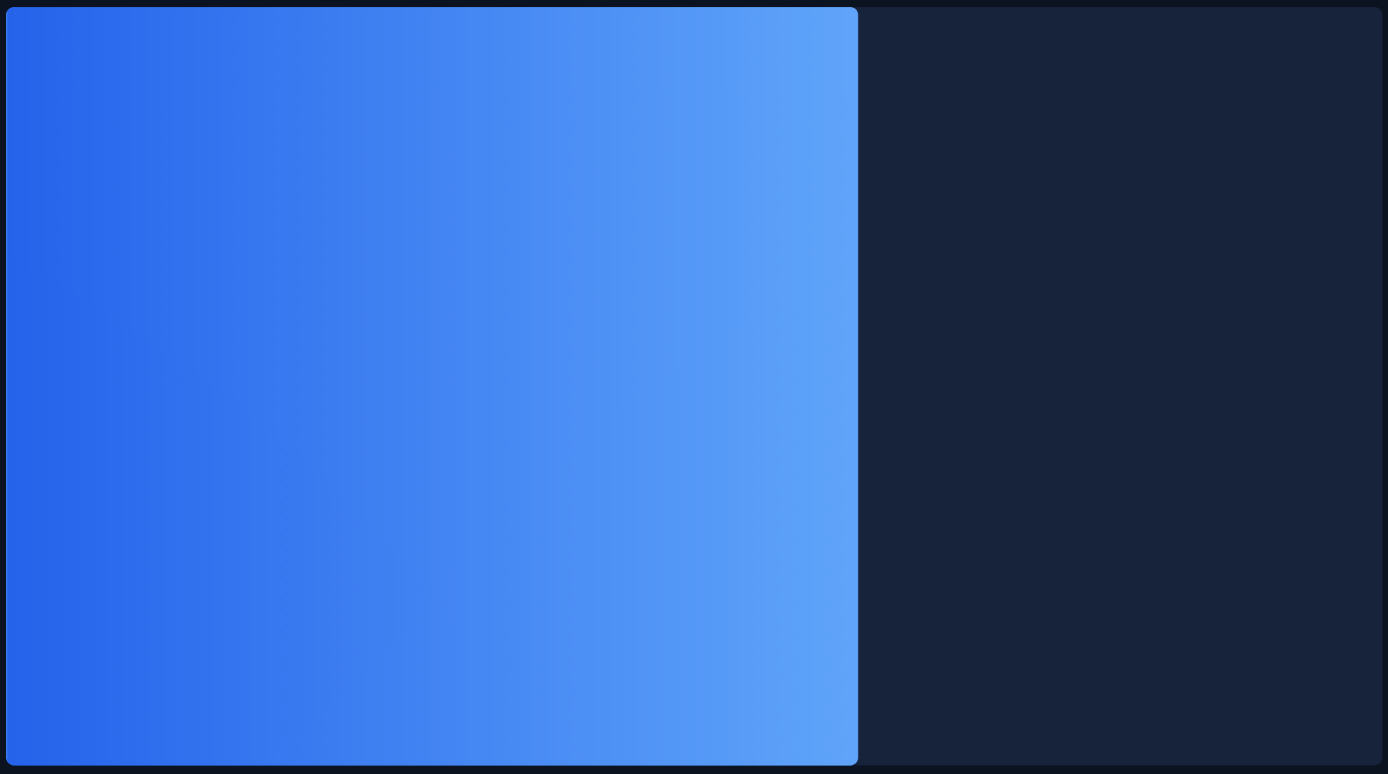
7	10,049	2,104	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

02 ImHex

github.com/WerWolv/ImHex

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 55.3k	GITHUB STARS
2,533	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
C++	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"🔍 A Hex Editor for Reverse Engineers, Programmers and people who value their retinas when working at 3 AM."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the hex editor with pattern language: parse formats while you view them.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by reverse engineers parsing binaries with a pattern language; the free hex editor built for RE workflows.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



6	2,533	412	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

03 jadx

github.com/skylot/jadx

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 51k	GITHUB STARS
5,821	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Java	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Dex to Java decompiler"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the standard Java/Android decompiler: dex-to-java source recovery with both GUI and CLI — the first stop for APK and JAR analysis.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by Android reverse engineers decompiling DEX to readable Java; the free decompiler every APK analysis starts with.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



13	5,821	457	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

04 x64dbg

github.com/x64dbg/x64dbg

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 49.9k	GITHUB STARS
2,873	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
C++	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"An open-source user mode debugger for Windows. Optimized for reverse engineering and malware analysis."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the open Windows debugger for x32/x64, with a plugin ecosystem built for RE.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by malware analysts debugging Windows binaries; the free Windows debugger that stands in for commercial debuggers.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11	2,873	578	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

05 mitmproxy

github.com/mitmproxy/mitmproxy

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 45.7k	GITHUB STARS
4,814	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2010	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"An interactive TLS-capable intercepting HTTP proxy for penetration testers and software developers."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

interactive HTTPS interception for debugging and testing your own apps; scriptable as a library.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by developers and pentesters intercepting HTTPS traffic programmatically; the free alternative to Charles Proxy and Fiddler.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



16	4,814	496	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

06 CyberChef

github.com/gchq/CyberChef

★ FLAGSHIP PICK · ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 36.1k	GITHUB STARS
4,176	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
JavaScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The Cyber Swiss Army Knife - a web app for encryption, encoding, compression and data analysis"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

GCHQ's web Swiss-army knife: 400+ operations for decoding, transforming and analyzing data, all client-side.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by analysts daily for decoding, crypto and data wrangling; GCHQ's free web tool that replaces a shelf of utilities.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



10	4,176	600	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

07 Netron

github.com/lutzroeder/netron

★ FLAGSHIP PICK · ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 33.6k	GITHUB STARS
3,189	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2010	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
JavaScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Visualizer for neural network, deep learning and machine learning models"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

visualize ML models: the layers, weights and graph of what you deploy.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by ML engineers inspecting model architectures; the free visualizer for neural-network files.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



16	3,189	18	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

08 OpenSSL

github.com/openssl/openssl

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 31k	GITHUB STARS
11,526	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"General purpose TLS and crypto library"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the TLS library the internet runs on — and the CLI for keys, certs, CSRs and everything crypto.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by literally everyone through the TLS it provides; the open library the commercial internet runs on.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



13	11,526	1,565	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

09 Apktool

github.com/iBotPeaches/Apktool

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 26k	GITHUB STARS
4,050	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Java	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A tool for reverse engineering Android apk files"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

disassemble and rebuild Android APKs: decode resources to near-original form, patch smali, repackage and sign — the Android RE classic.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by mobile pentesters decoding Android resources and smali; the standard free APK disassembler.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



14	4,050	78	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

10 radare2

github.com/radareorg/radare2

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 25.1k	GITHUB STARS
3,364	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"UNIX-like reverse engineering framework and command-line toolset"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the scriptable reverse-engineering framework: disassemble, debug, patch, anywhere.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by reverse engineers scripting binary analysis; the free framework that powers many commercial RE pipelines.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



14	3,364	789	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

11 Frida

github.com/frida/frida

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 22.3k	GITHUB STARS
2,260	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Meson	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Main repo for hosting release binaries"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

inject JavaScript into running processes; dynamic instrumentation for mobile, desktop and IoT.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by mobile pentesters and researchers injecting logic into running processes; the dynamic-instrumentation standard.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



13	2,260	1,973	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

12 Ciphey

github.com/Ciphey/Ciphey

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 21.7k	GITHUB STARS
1,446	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2019	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Rust	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"⚡ Automatically decrypt encryptions without knowing the key or cipher, decode encodings, and crack hashes ⚡"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

automated decoder: paste ciphertext, get plaintext plus the method used — evidence triage in seconds.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTF players and analysts auto-decoding ciphertext; the free automated decoder.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



7	1,446	66	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

13 Cutter

github.com/rizinorg/cutter

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 20k	GITHUB STARS
1,520	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
C++	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Free and Open Source Reverse Engineering Platform powered by rizin"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

free and open reverse-engineering platform powered by rizin: graph disassembly, decompiler views and debugging in a polished desktop UI.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by RE learners driving Ghidra through a friendlier GUI; the free reverse-engineering IDE.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



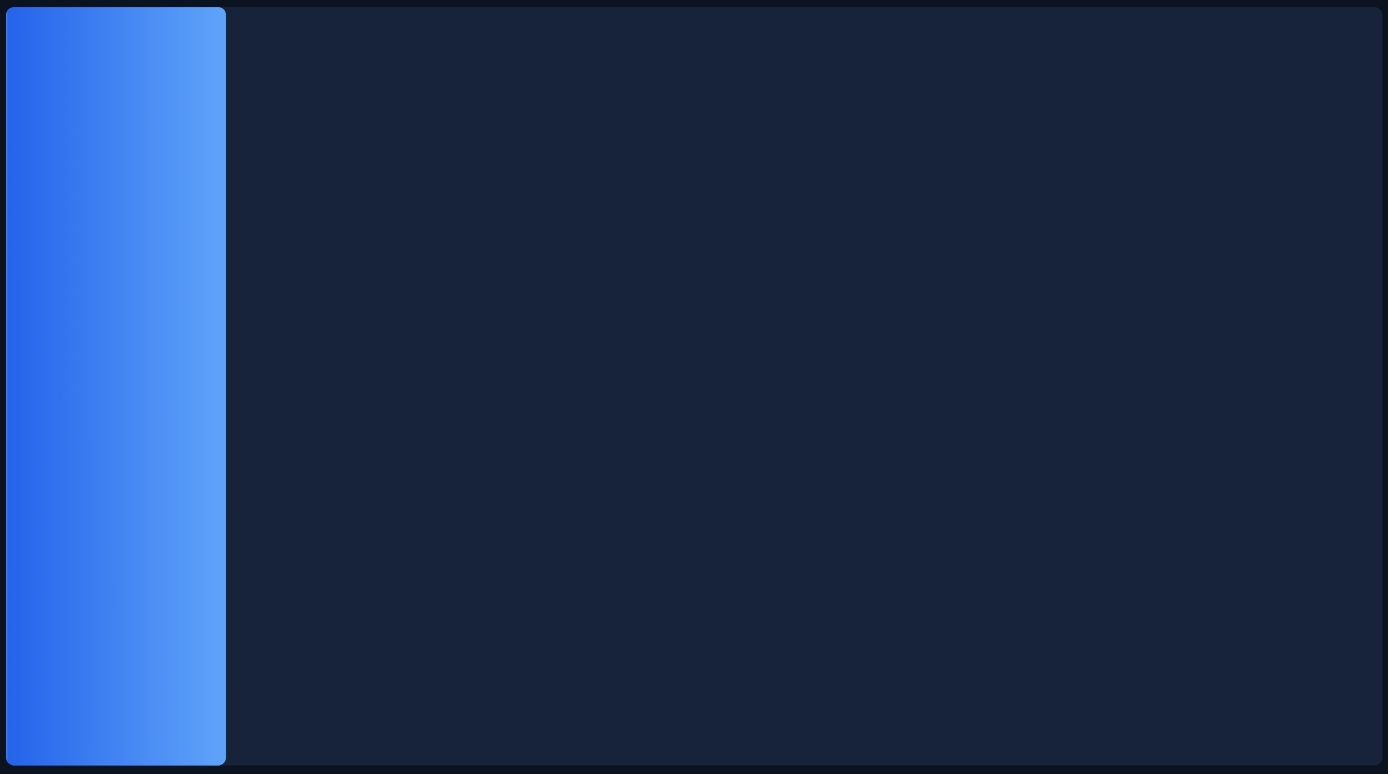
9	1,520	499	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

14 binwalk

github.com/ReFirmLabs/binwalk

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 14.5k	GITHUB STARS
1,852	FORKS
2026-08	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Rust	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Firmware Analysis Tool"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

firmware analysis: scan, extract and identify embedded files and filesystems.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by firmware researchers extracting embedded filesystems and images; the standard free firmware-analysis tool.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

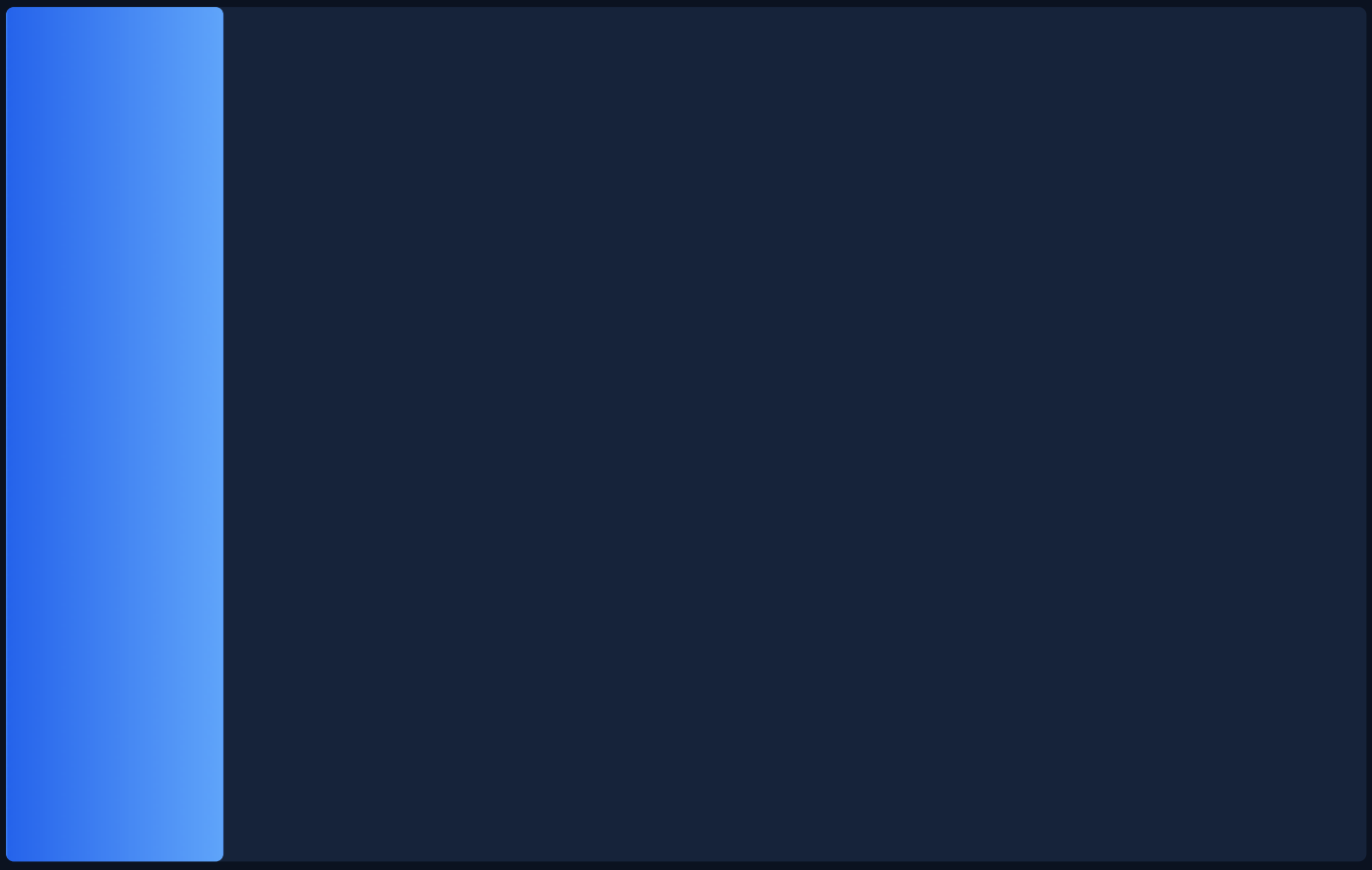


13	1,852	100	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

15 Awesome Malware Analysis

github.com/rshipp/awesome-malware-analysis

star weight vs realm #1



★ 14.3k	GITHUB STARS
2,691	FORKS
2024-06	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
—	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Defund the Police.”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the curated malware-analysis tool index. Used by malware analysts assembling their toolkit.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



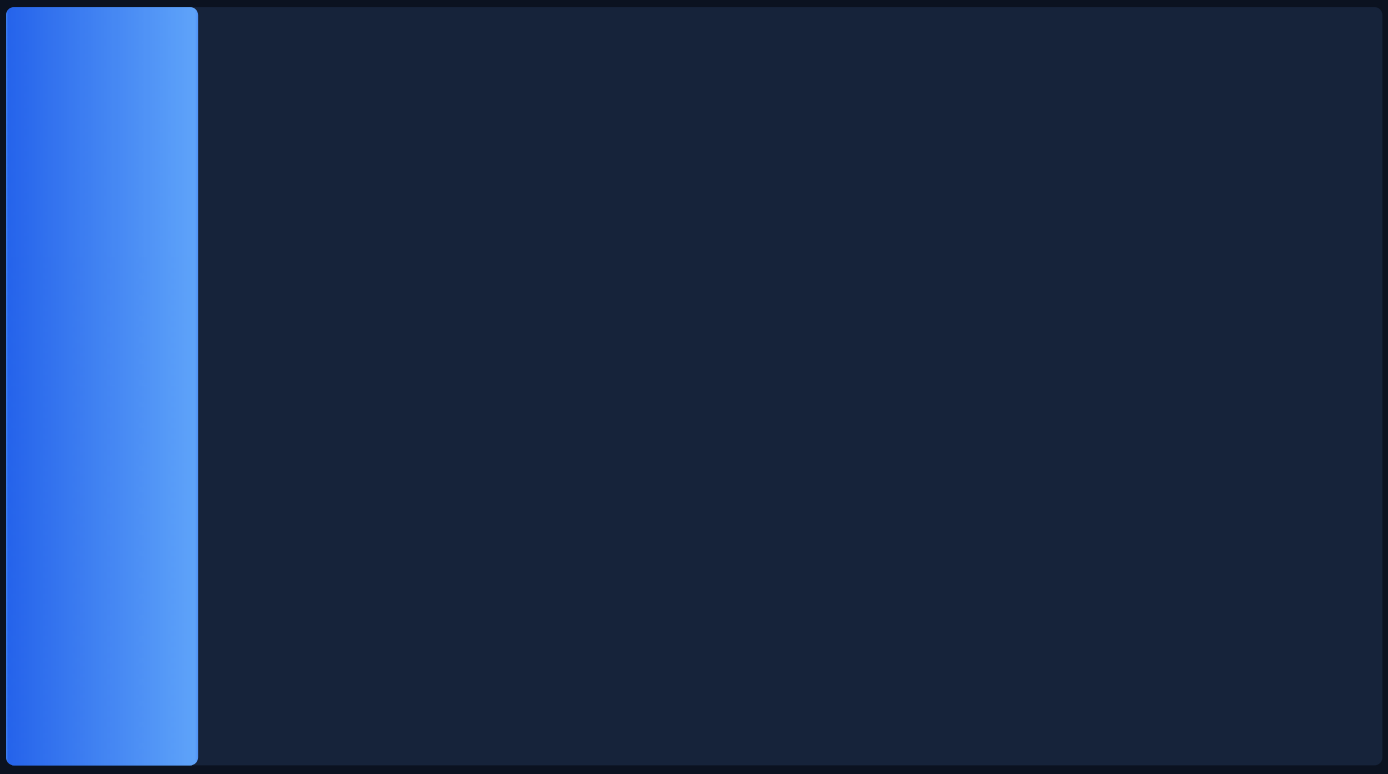
11	2,691	25	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

16 Scapy

github.com/secdev/scapy

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 12.6k	GITHUB STARS
2,269	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Scapy: the Python-based interactive packet manipulation program & library."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

packet crafting without limits: forge, sniff, dissect and send anything — the Python network Swiss-army knife.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by network researchers crafting packets in Python; the standard library protocol testing builds on.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



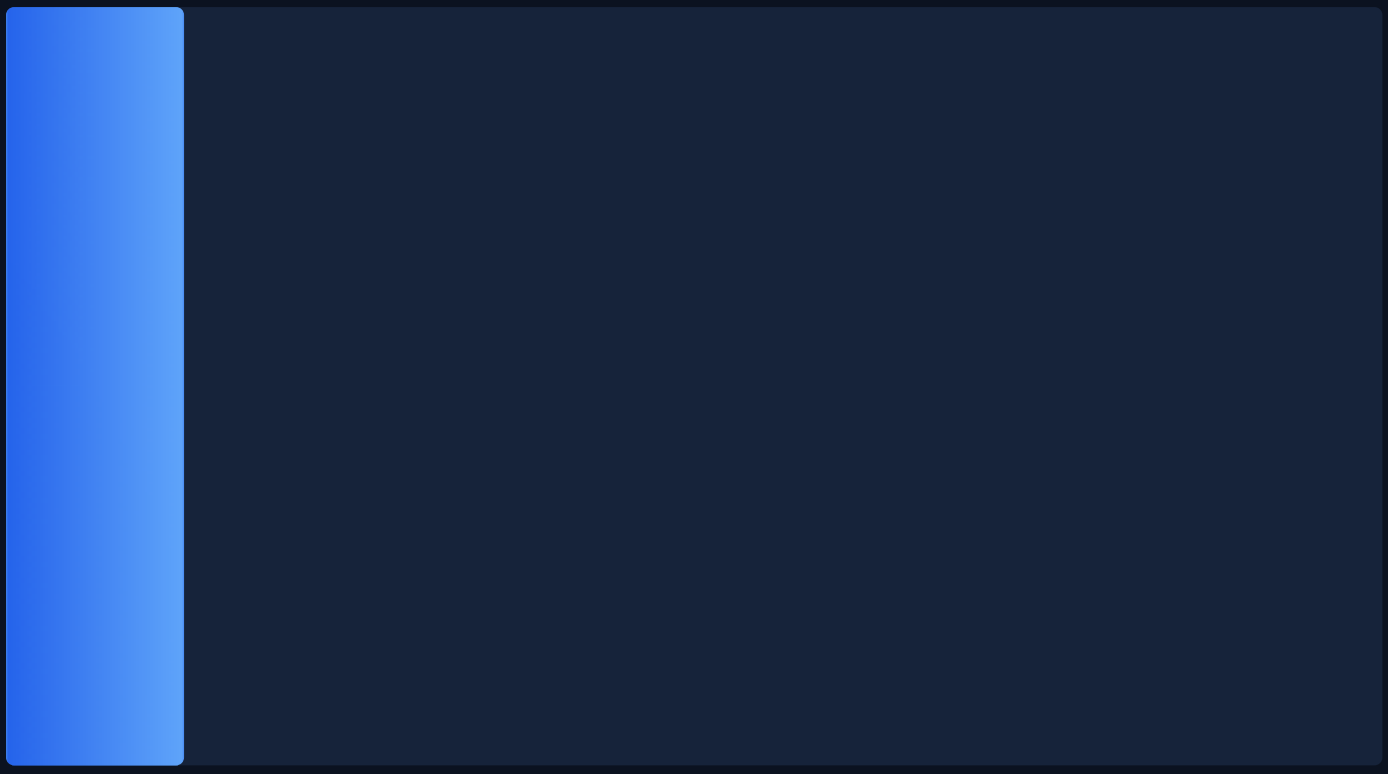
11	2,269	148	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

17 Detect It Easy

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/horsicq/Detect-It-Easy

star weight vs realm #1



★ 11.7k	GITHUB STARS
982	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
JavaScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Program for determining types of files for Windows, Linux and MacOS."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

packer/compiler/protection detection with a rule engine.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by malware analysts identifying packers and compilers; the free packer-detection standard.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



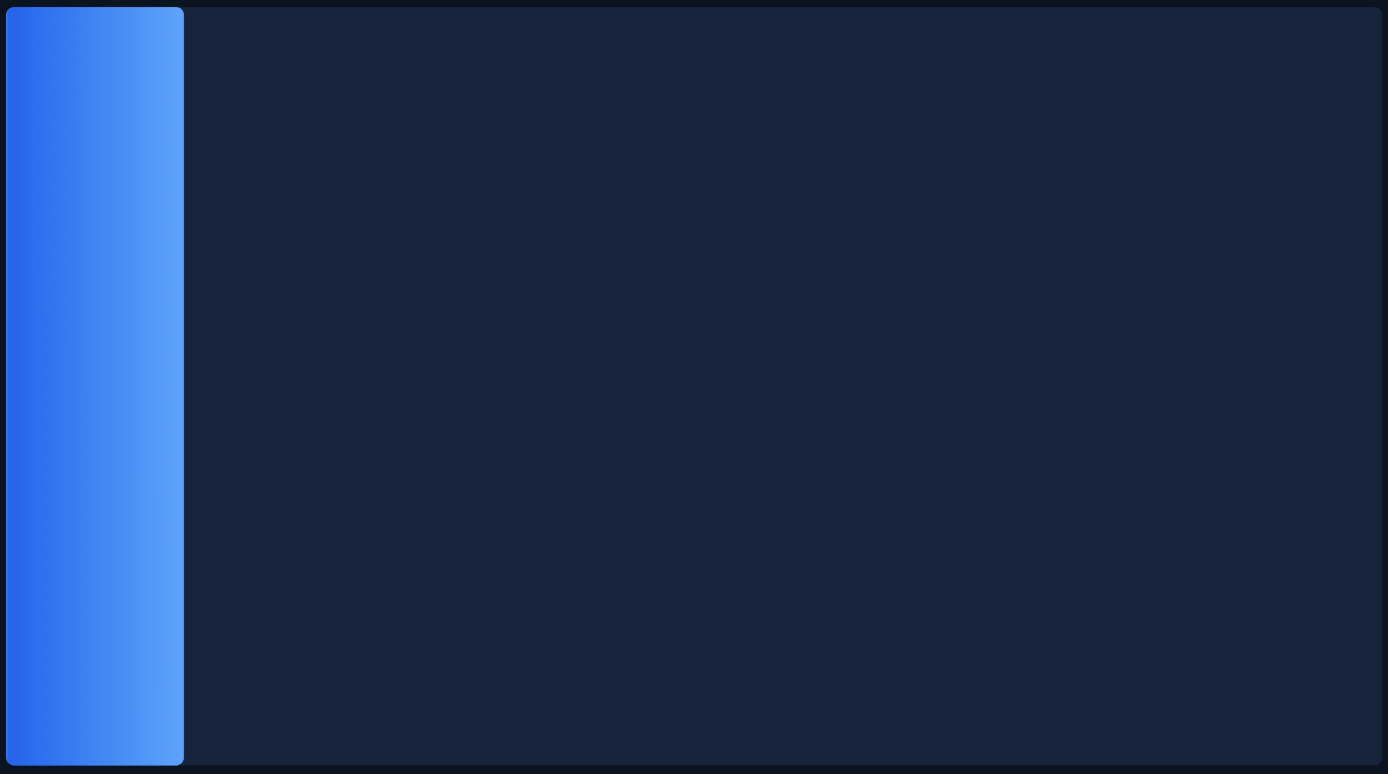
12	982	34	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

18 dnSpyEx

github.com/dnSpyEx/dnSpy

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 11.3k	GITHUB STARS
756	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2021	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
C#	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Unofficial revival of the well known .NET debugger and assembly editor, dnSpy"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the .NET debugger and decompiler, continued; edit assemblies live.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by .NET researchers decompiling and debugging managed code; the maintained fork of the classic .NET debugger.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



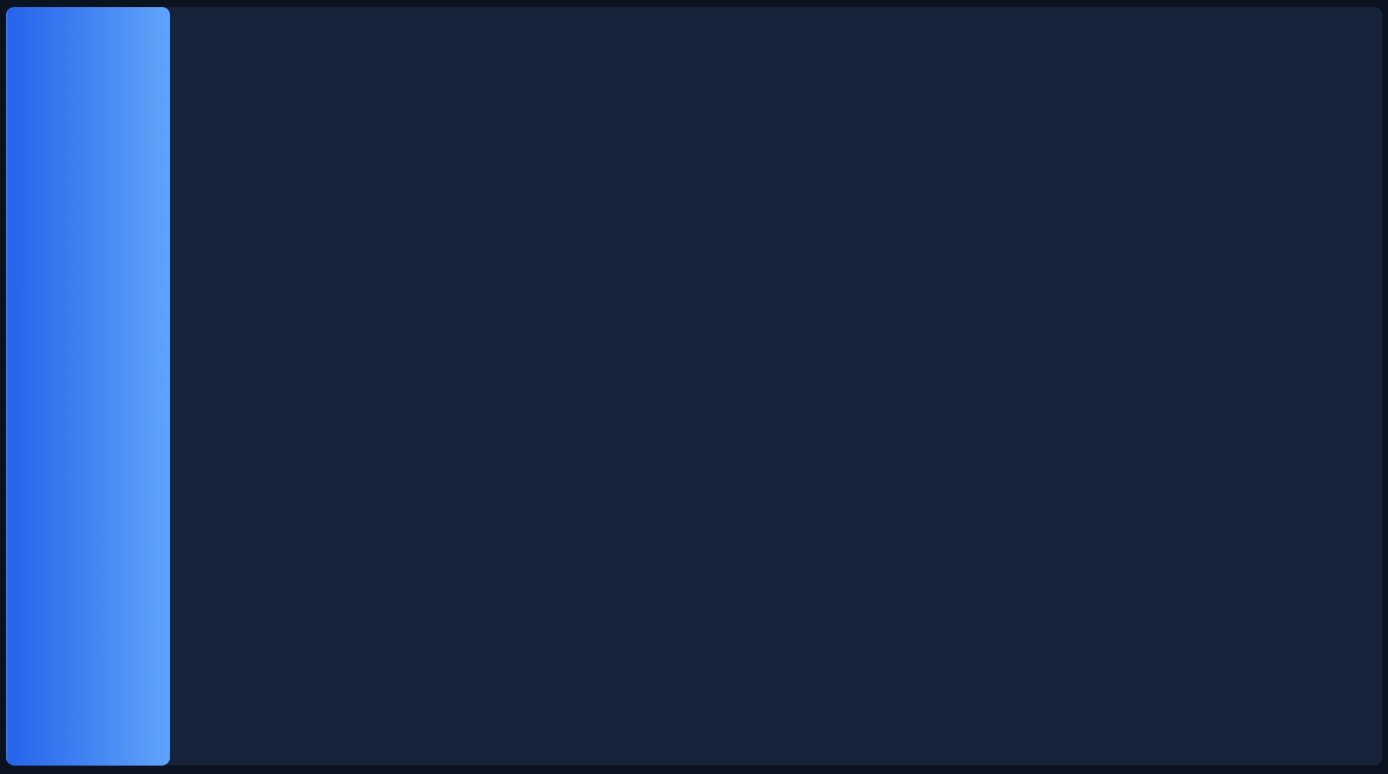
5	756	150	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

19 pwndbg

github.com/pwndbg/pwndbg

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 11.1k	GITHUB STARS
1,293	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Exploit Development and Reverse Engineering with GDB & LLDB Made Easy"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

GDB with a exploit-dev UX: heap awareness, shortcuts and sane defaults.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTF players and exploit developers making GDB pwn-friendly; the standard GDB plugin for exploitation work.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



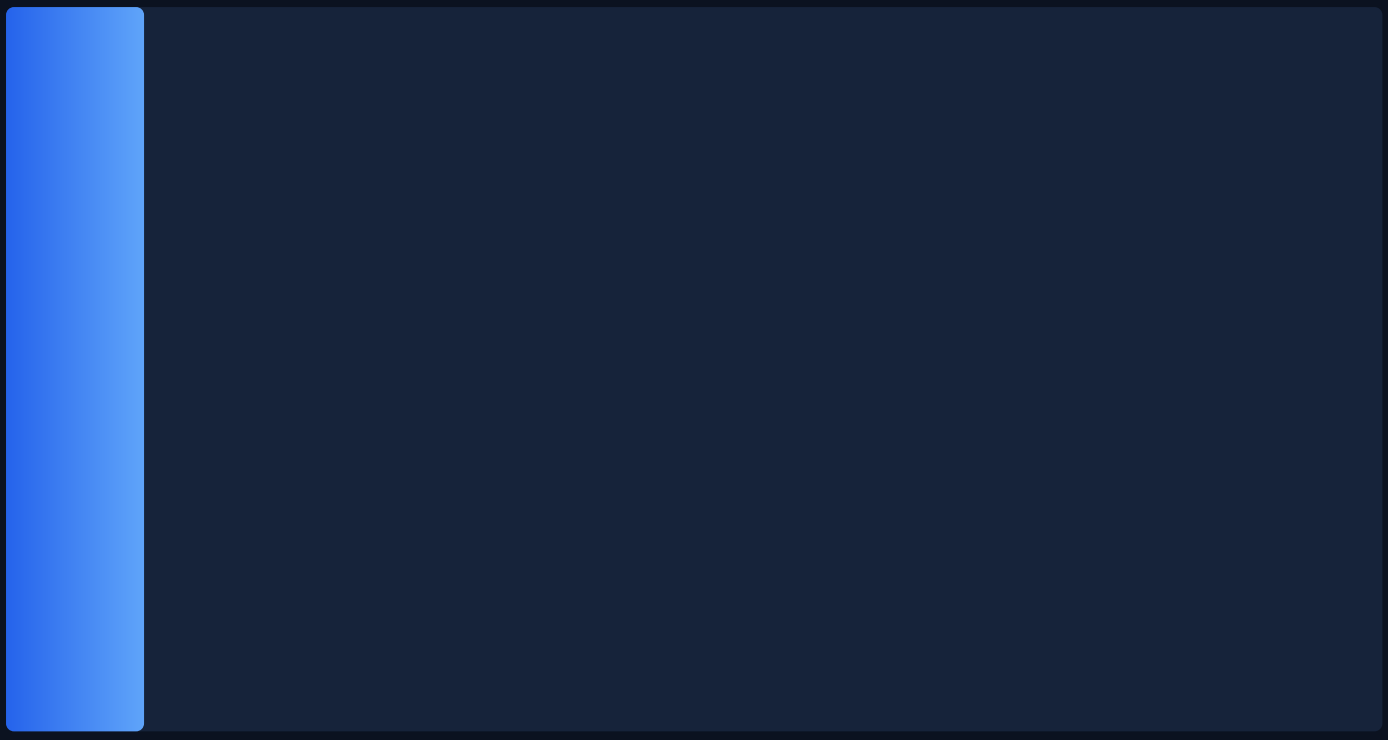
11	1,293	238	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

20 Capstone

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/capstone-engine/capstone

star weight vs realm #1



★ 9.1k	GITHUB STARS
1,741	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
None	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Capstone disassembly/disassembler framework for ARM, ARM64 (ARMv8), Alpha, BPF, Ethereum VM, HPPA, LoongArch, M68K, M680X, Mips, MOS65XX, PPC, RISC-V(rv32G/rv64G), SH, Sparc, SystemZ, TMS320C64X, TriCore, Webassembly, XC”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the disassembly framework behind countless security tools.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by security developers embedding disassembly; the free engine behind countless RE and EDR tools.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



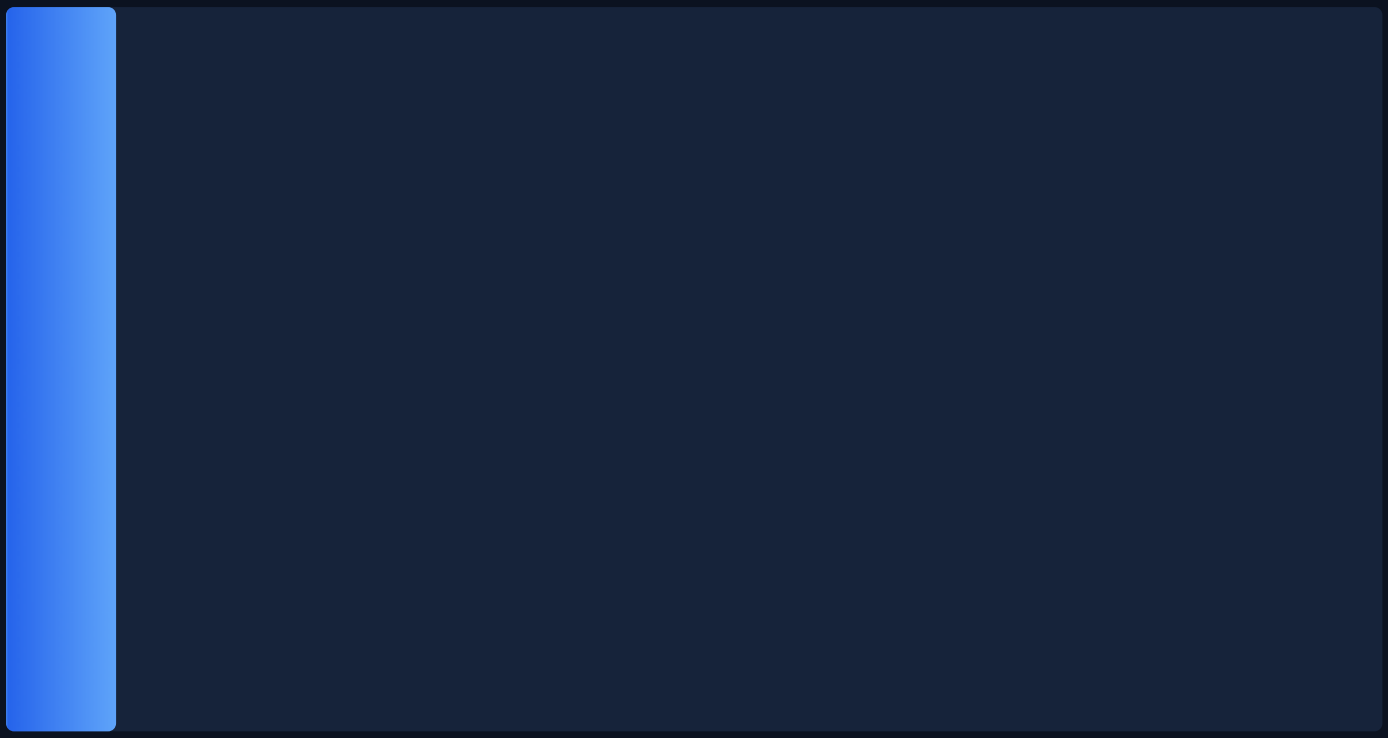
13	1,741	359	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

21 pyWhat

github.com/bee-san/pyWhat

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 7.3k	GITHUB STARS
392	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2021	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"🐸 Identify anything. pyWhat easily lets you identify emails, IP addresses, and more. Feed it a .pcap file or some text and it'll tell you what it is! 🔏"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

identify anything: hashes, keys, URLs, PII — the "what is this string?" answer.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by analysts identifying arbitrary blobs and strings; the free 'what is this' identifier.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



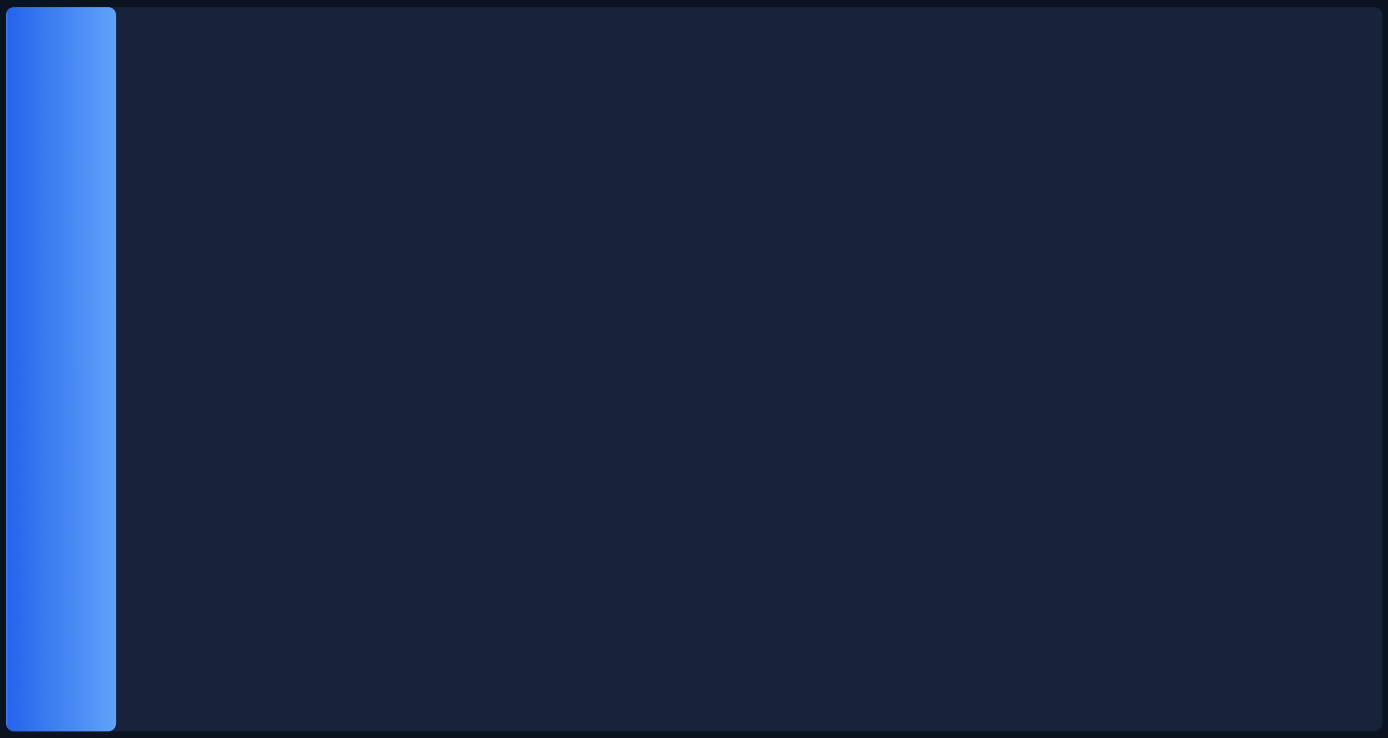
5	392	3	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

22 Faraday

github.com/infobyte/faraday

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.8k	GITHUB STARS
1,077	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Open-source and AI-powered cybersecurity tools for offensive security, vulnerability management, and autonomous pentesting. Built by hackers in Latin America, used worldwide."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the pentest collaboration platform: import tool output, deduplicate findings and manage the whole engagement.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentest teams collaborating on findings; the community edition of the commercial collaboration platform.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

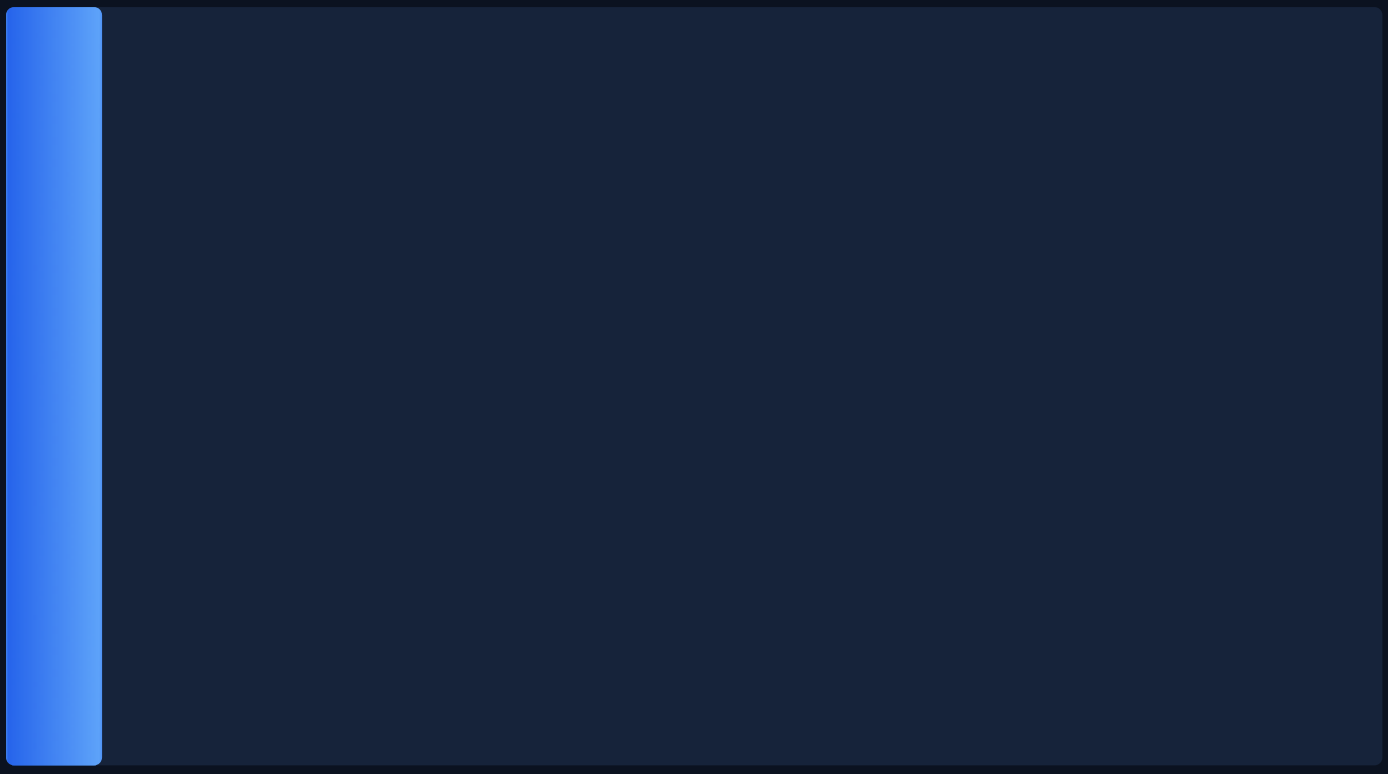


13	1,077	16	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

23 Voltron

github.com/snare/voltron

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.3k	GITHUB STARS
420	FORKS
2025-01	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A hacky debugger UI for hackers"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

a debugger-agnostic UI: multiple synchronized views across GDB/LLDB.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by exploit developers unifying GDB, lldb and radare2 views; the free debugger-UI multiplexer.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



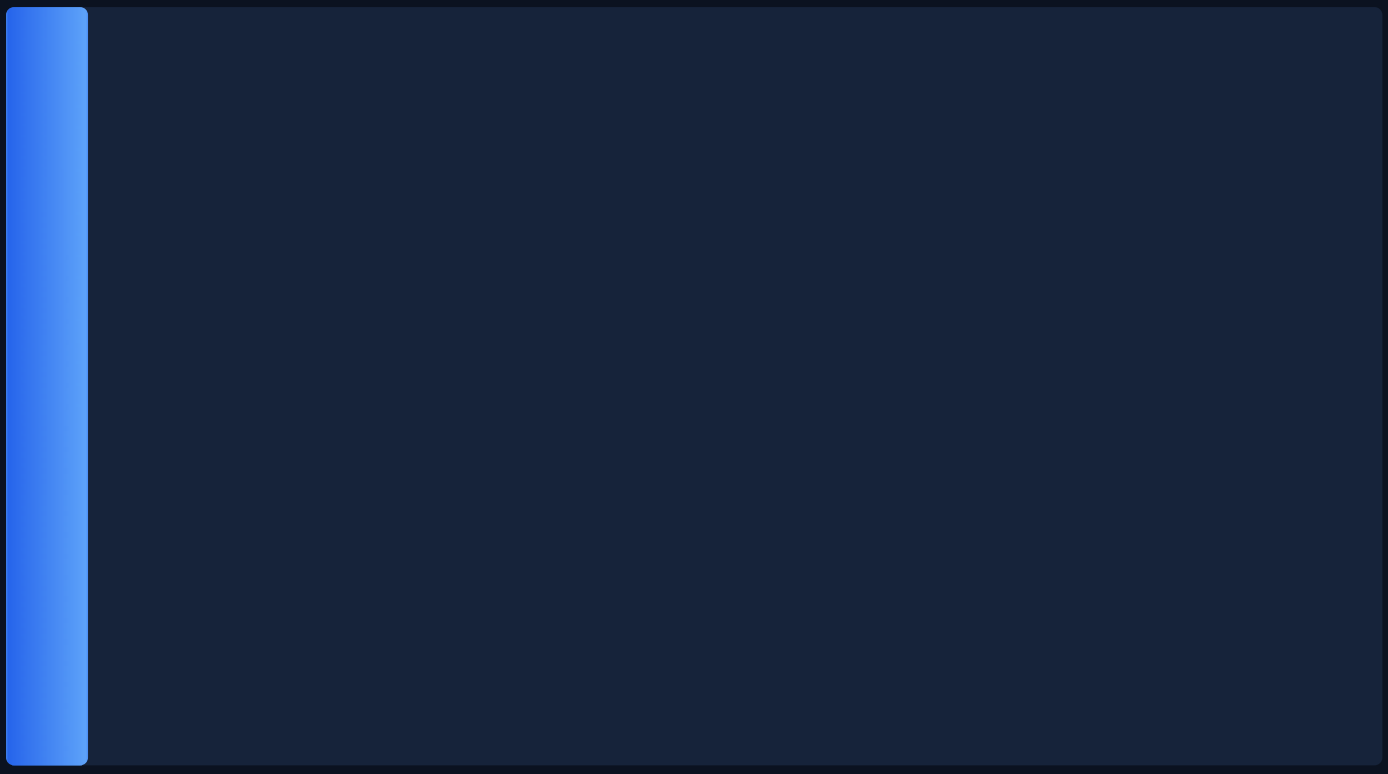
13	420	85	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

24 Dangerzone

github.com/freedomofpress/dangerzone

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.8k	GITHUB STARS
274	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
AGPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Take potentially dangerous PDFs, office documents, or images and convert them to safe PDFs"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

takes hostile documents and re-renders them as safe PDFs inside an isolated sandbox.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by newsrooms converting untrusted documents into safe PDFs; the free sanitization tool for adversarial files.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



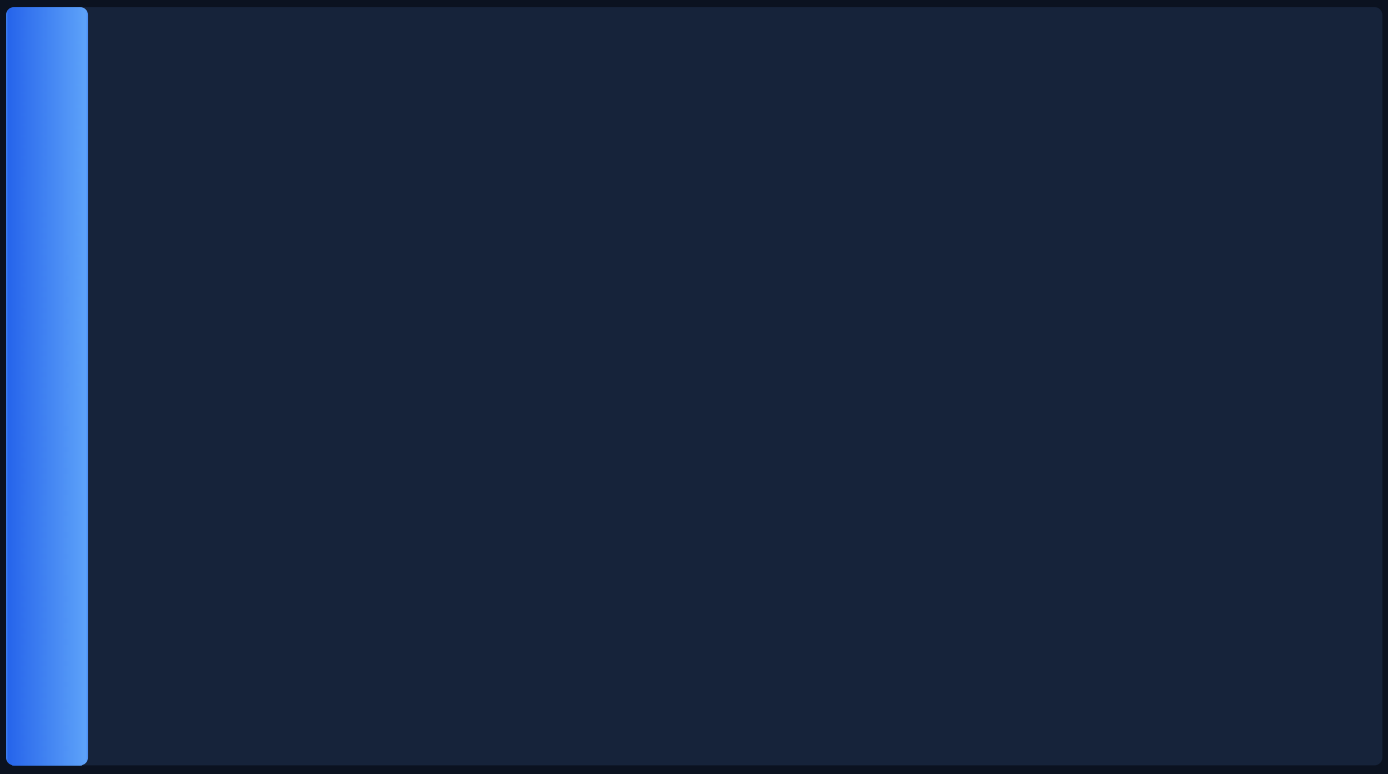
6	274	195	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

25 UEFITool

github.com/LongSoft/UEFITool

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.8k	GITHUB STARS
760	FORKS
2026-07	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
BSD-2-Clause	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"UEFI firmware image viewer and editor"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

parse, extract and replace UEFI firmware images.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by firmware analysts parsing UEFI images; the free tool for BIOS/UEFI research.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



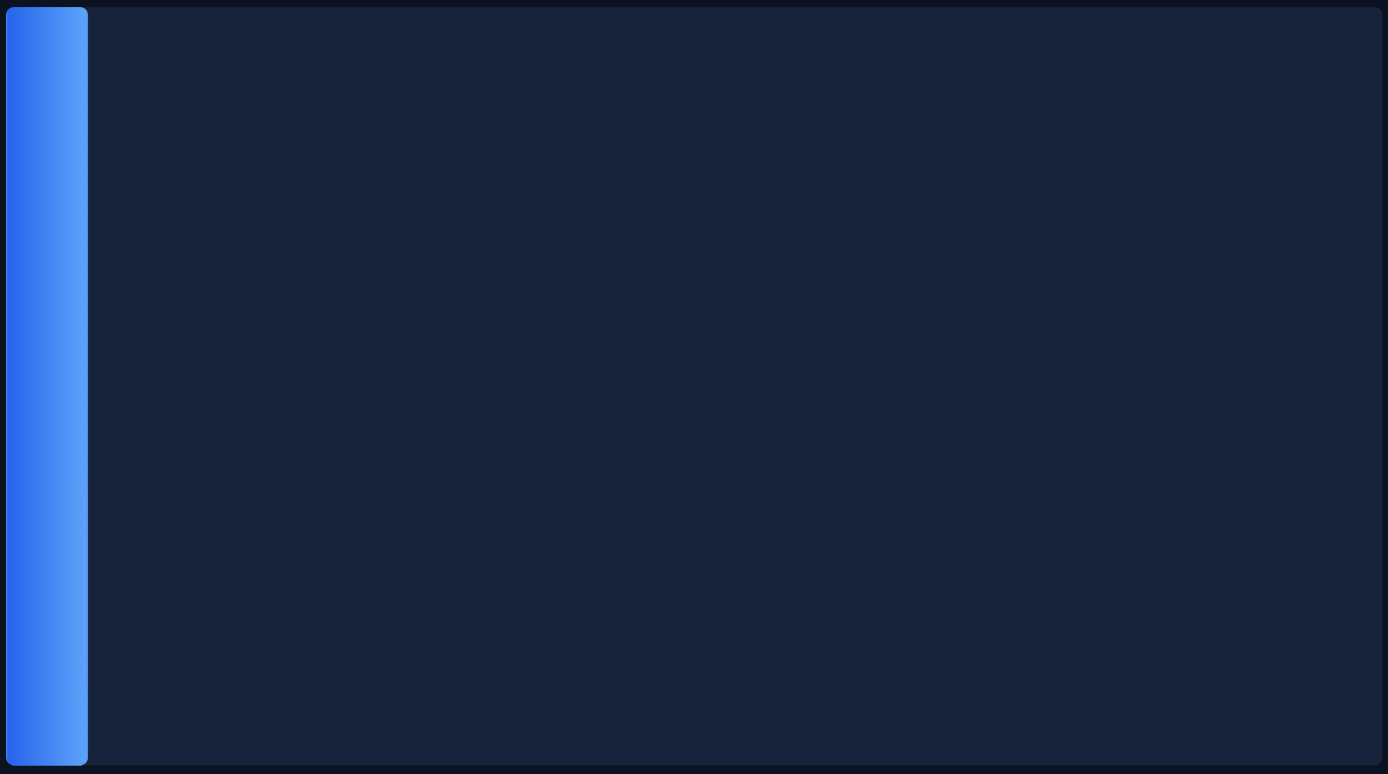
13	760	25	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

26 ExifTool

github.com/exiftool/exiftool

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.2k	GITHUB STARS
492	FORKS
2026-05	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Perl	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"ExifTool meta information reader/writer"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the metadata reader/writer for files and images; the last word in metadata triage.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by investigators reading and stripping file metadata; the standard free metadata tool used across forensics. (Perl Artistic/GPL)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



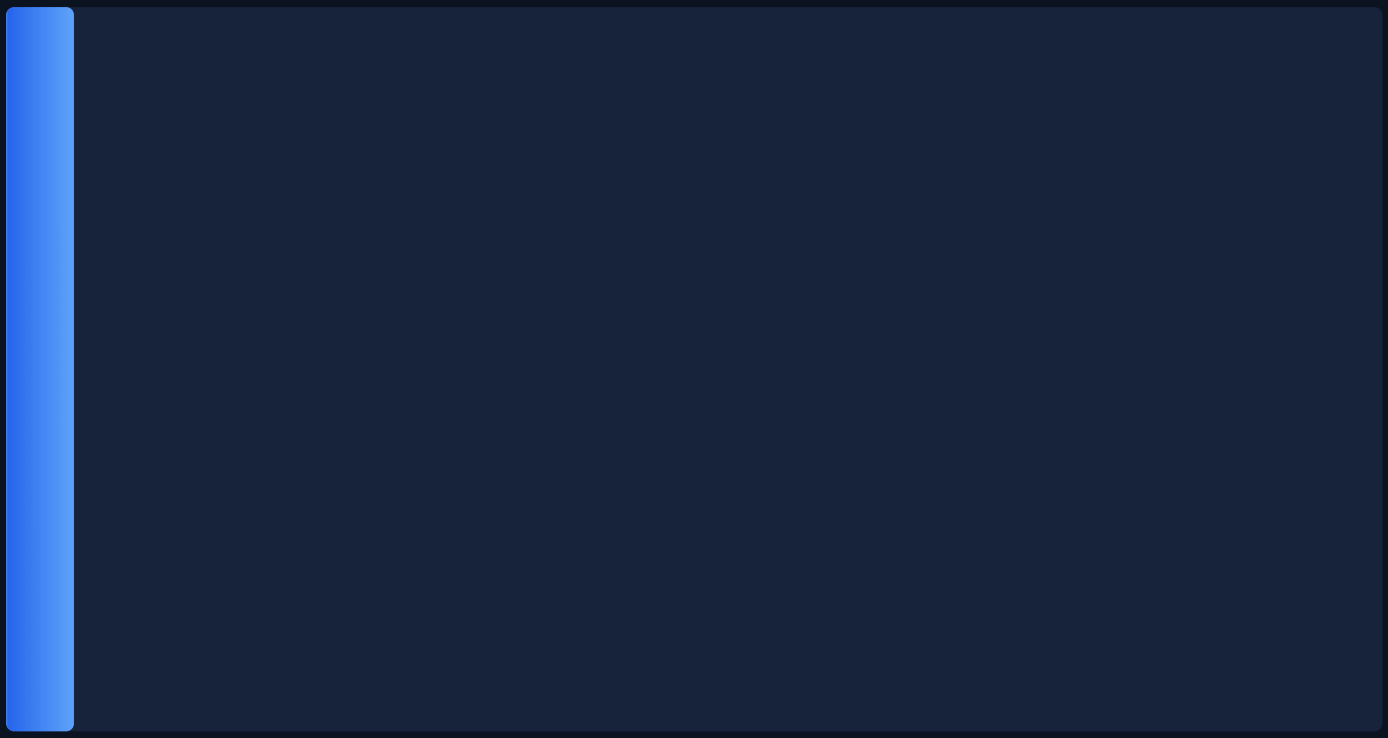
8	492	48	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

27 Kaitai Struct

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/kaitai-io/kaitai_struct

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.7k	GITHUB STARS
211	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
None	LICENSE
Shell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Kaitai Struct: declarative language to generate binary data parsers in C++ / C# / Go / Java / JavaScript / Lua / Nim / Perl / PHP / Python / Ruby / Rust"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

declare a binary format once, generate parsers for nine languages.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by protocol researchers declaring binary formats as YAML; the free declarative parser generator for format RE.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



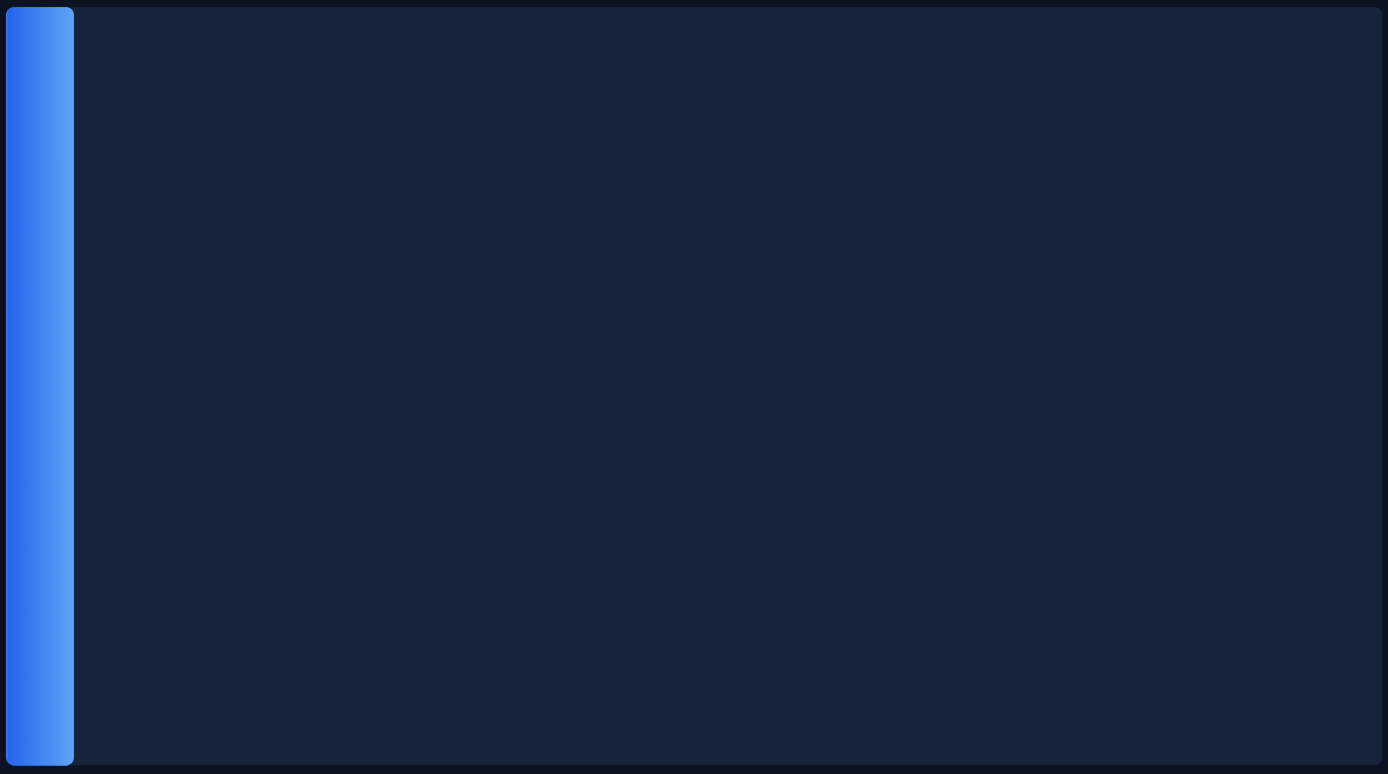
10	211	528	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

28 Interactsh

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/projectdiscovery/interactsh

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.6k	GITHUB STARS
487	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2021	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"An OOB interaction gathering server and client library"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

out-of-band interaction server for detecting blind vulnerabilities (SSRF, blind RCE, blind XXE).

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by bug hunters detecting out-of-band interactions blind spots miss; ProjectDiscovery's free alternative to Burp Collaborator.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



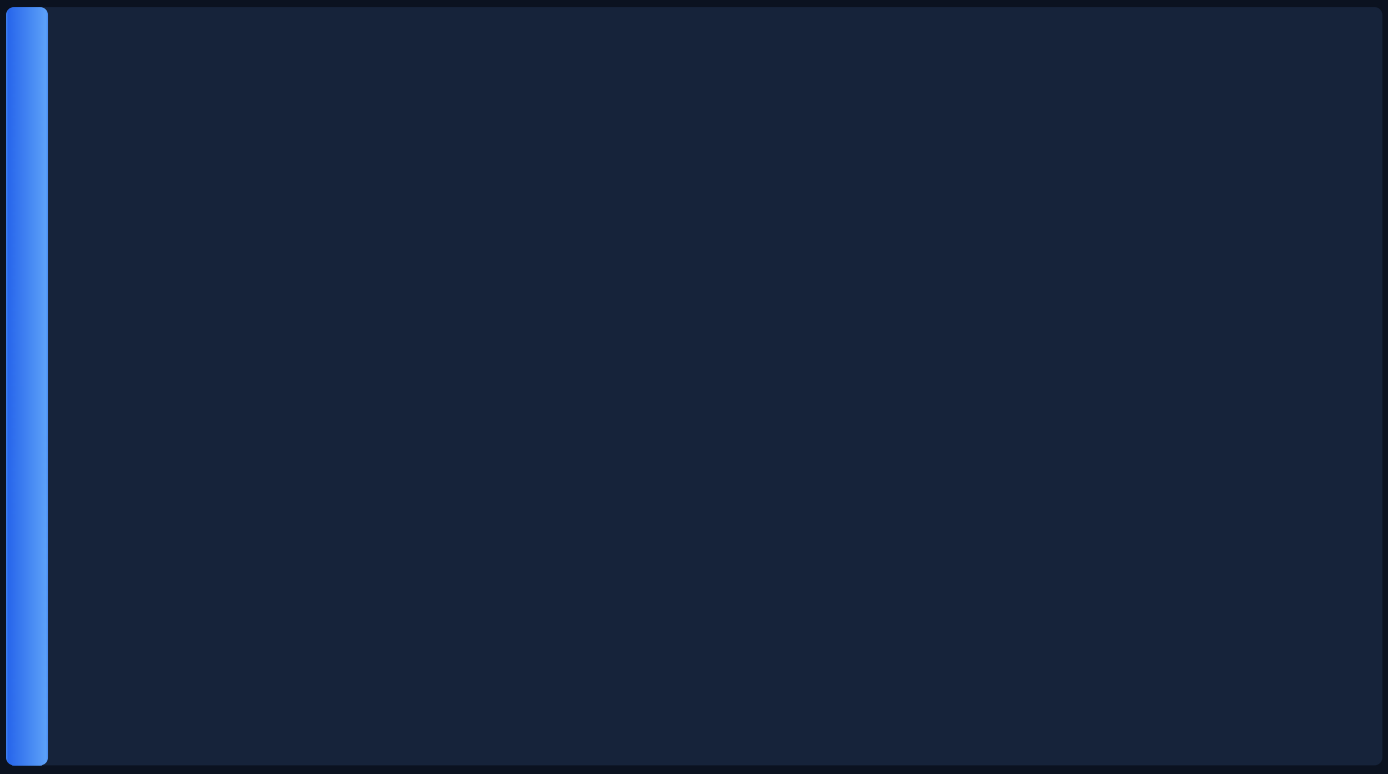
5	487	3	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

29 ATT&CK Navigator

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/mitre-attack/attack-navigator

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.5k	GITHUB STARS
714	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
TypeScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Web app that provides basic navigation and annotation of ATT&CK matrices"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

MITRE's matrix explorer: layer, annotate and score ATT&CK techniques for detection-coverage planning.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by purple teams planning and visualizing coverage; the free MITRE tool for layer-based ATT&CK exploration.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



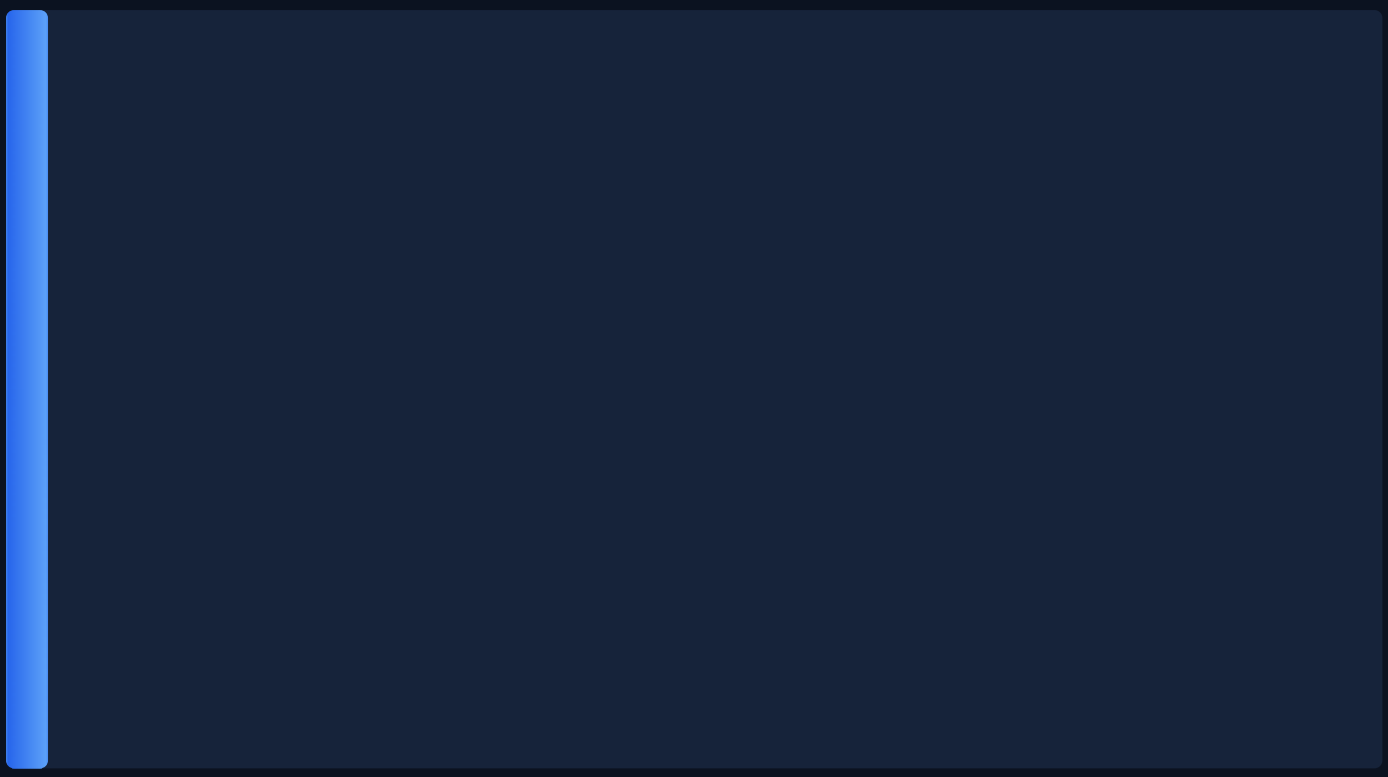
8	714	82	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

30 boofuzz

github.com/jtpereyda/boofuzz

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.4k	GITHUB STARS
383	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A fork and successor of the Sulley Fuzzing Framework"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

network protocol fuzzing framework descended from Sulley — script your protocol and hardware bug hunts.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by protocol fuzzers finding crashes in network services; the open-source fuzzing framework from the Sulley lineage.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

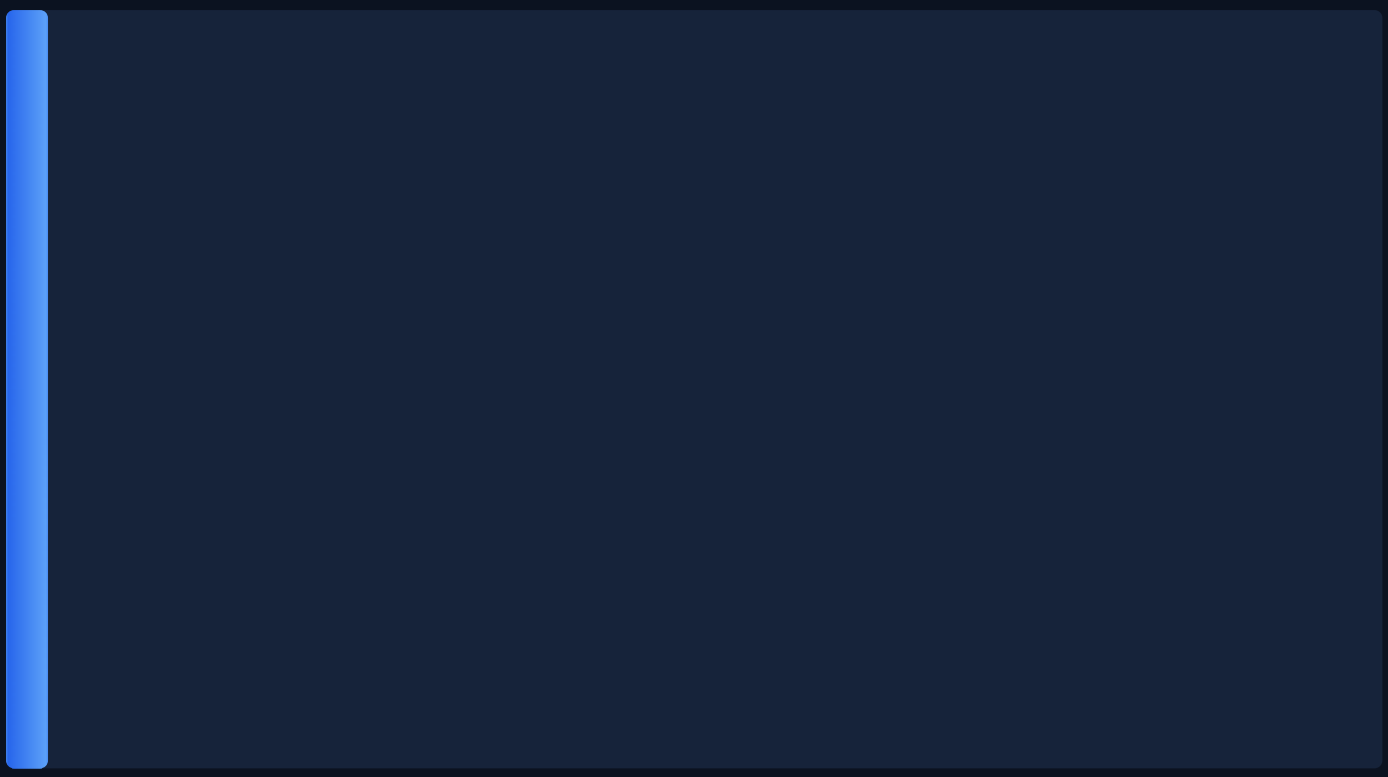


11	383	101	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

31 Brida

github.com/federicodotta/Brida

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.9k	GITHUB STARS
223	FORKS
2025-10	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Java	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The new bridge between Burp Suite and Frida!"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the bridge between Burp and Frida: custom instrumentation in your proxy workflow.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by mobile pentesters bridging Frida into Burp; the free companion for SSL-pinning bypass work.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



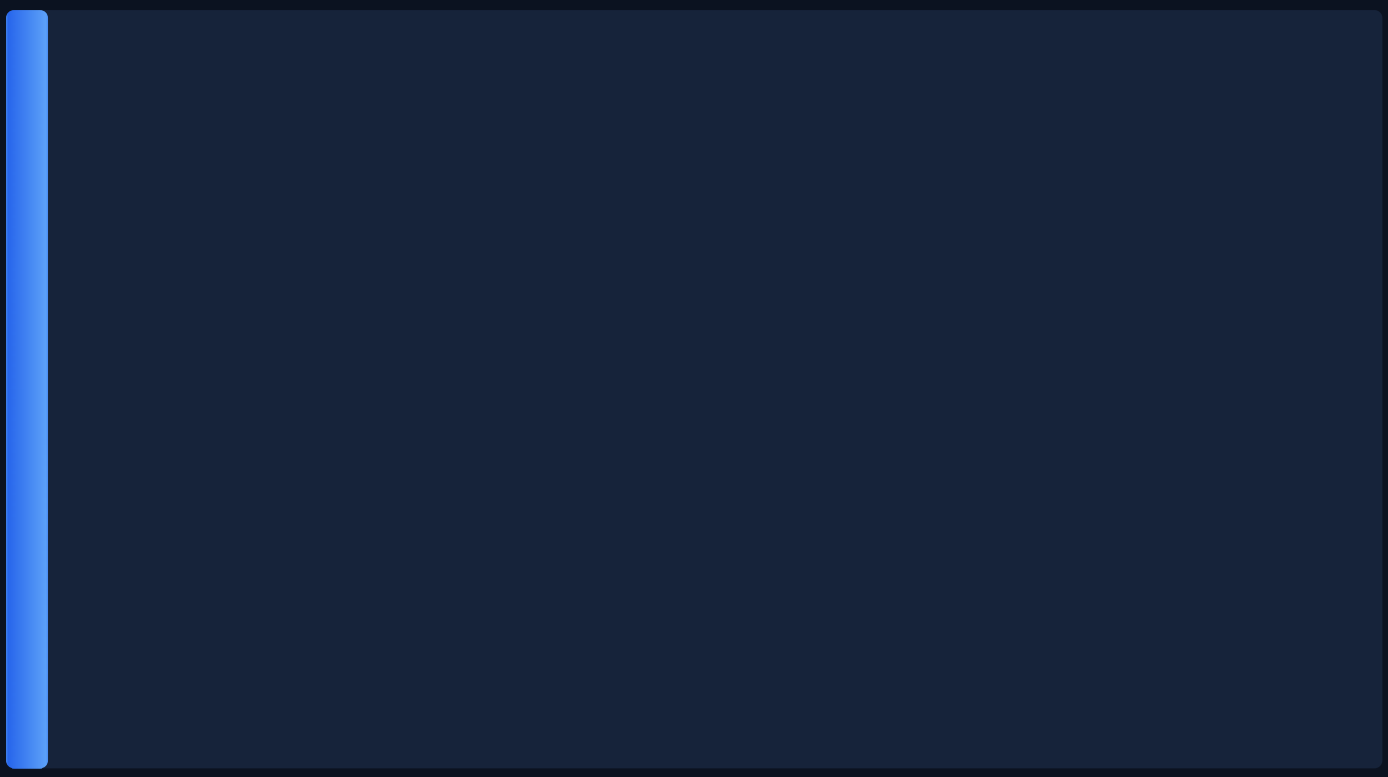
9	223	11	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

32 tcpreplay

github.com/appneta/tcpreplay

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.4k	GITHUB STARS
296	FORKS
2026-08	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

*"Edit and replay captured network traffic at arbitrary speeds — a suite of pcap tools for *NIX and Windows."*

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

replay captured traffic at arbitrary speed for testing and validation.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by engineers replaying captures at original speed; the free pcap replay tool for testing sensors.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



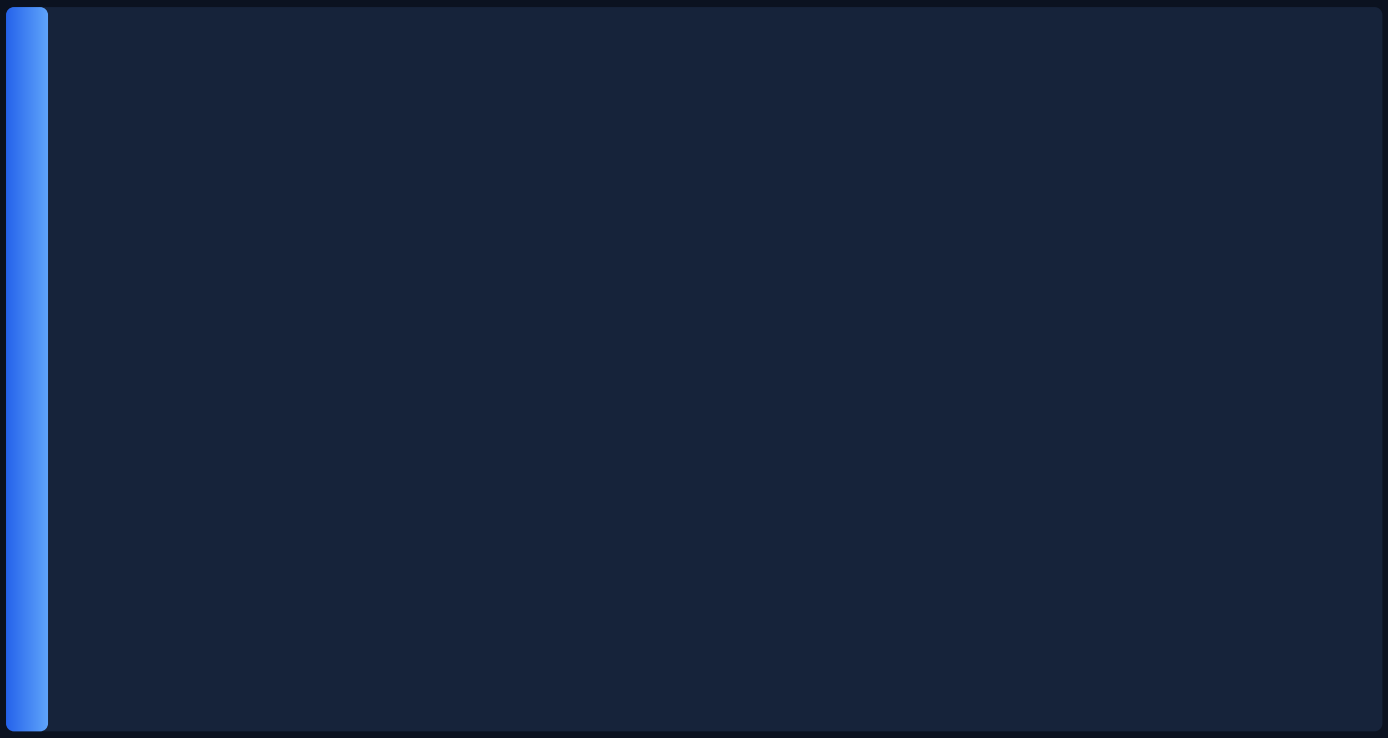
13	296	5	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

33 GnuPG

github.com/gpg/gnupg

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 991	GITHUB STARS
218	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The GNU Privacy Guard. NOTE: Maintainers are not tracking this mirror. Do not make pull requests here, nor comment any commits, submit them usual way to bug tracker (https://www.gnupg.org/documentation/bts.html) or to th"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the free implementation of OpenPGP: encrypt, sign and verify files and mail, everywhere.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by privacy-conscious users for email and file encryption; the free open implementation of OpenPGP.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



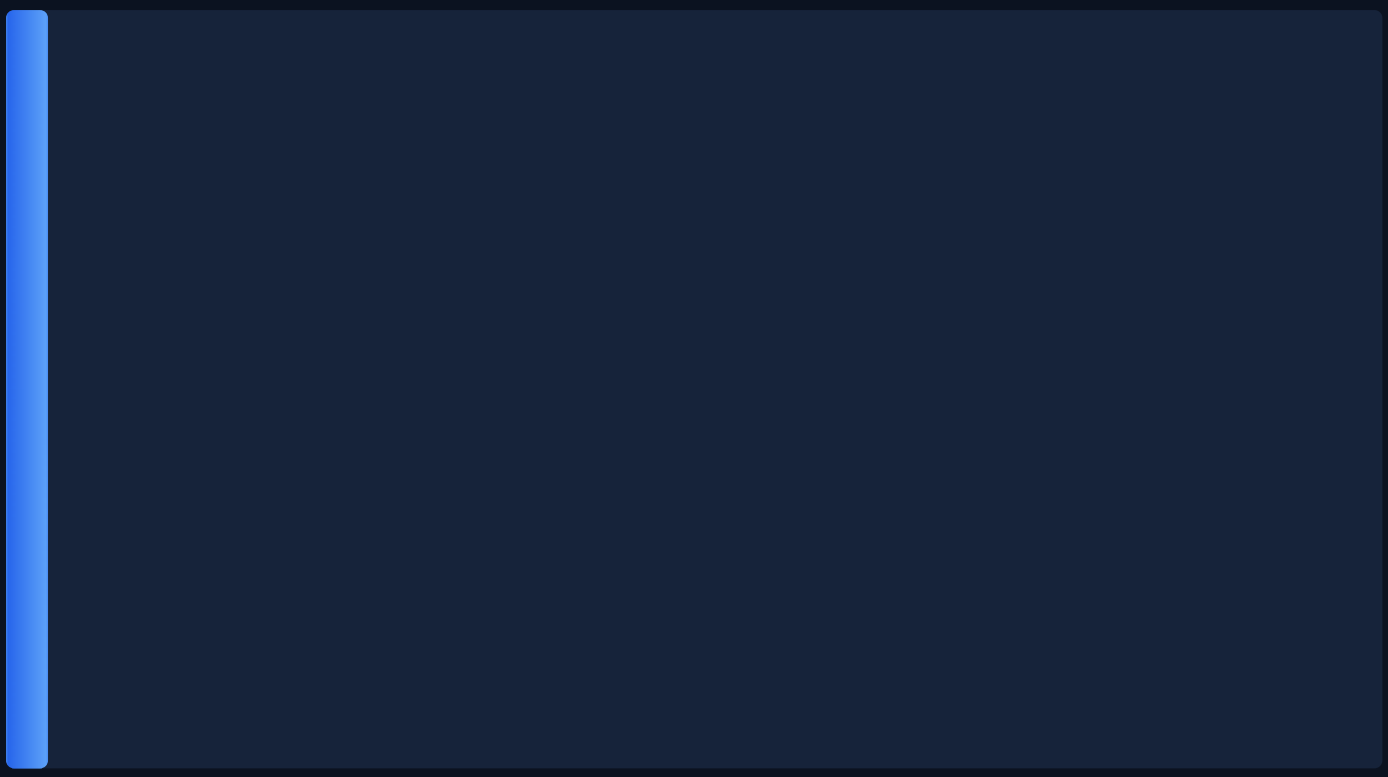
11	218	1	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

34 OCSF

github.com/ocsf/ocsf-schema

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 901	GITHUB STARS
229	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2022	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
—	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OCSF Schema"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Open Cybersecurity Schema Framework: one schema for security events.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by SIEM and security vendors normalizing telemetry; the open schema standard the industry is converging on.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



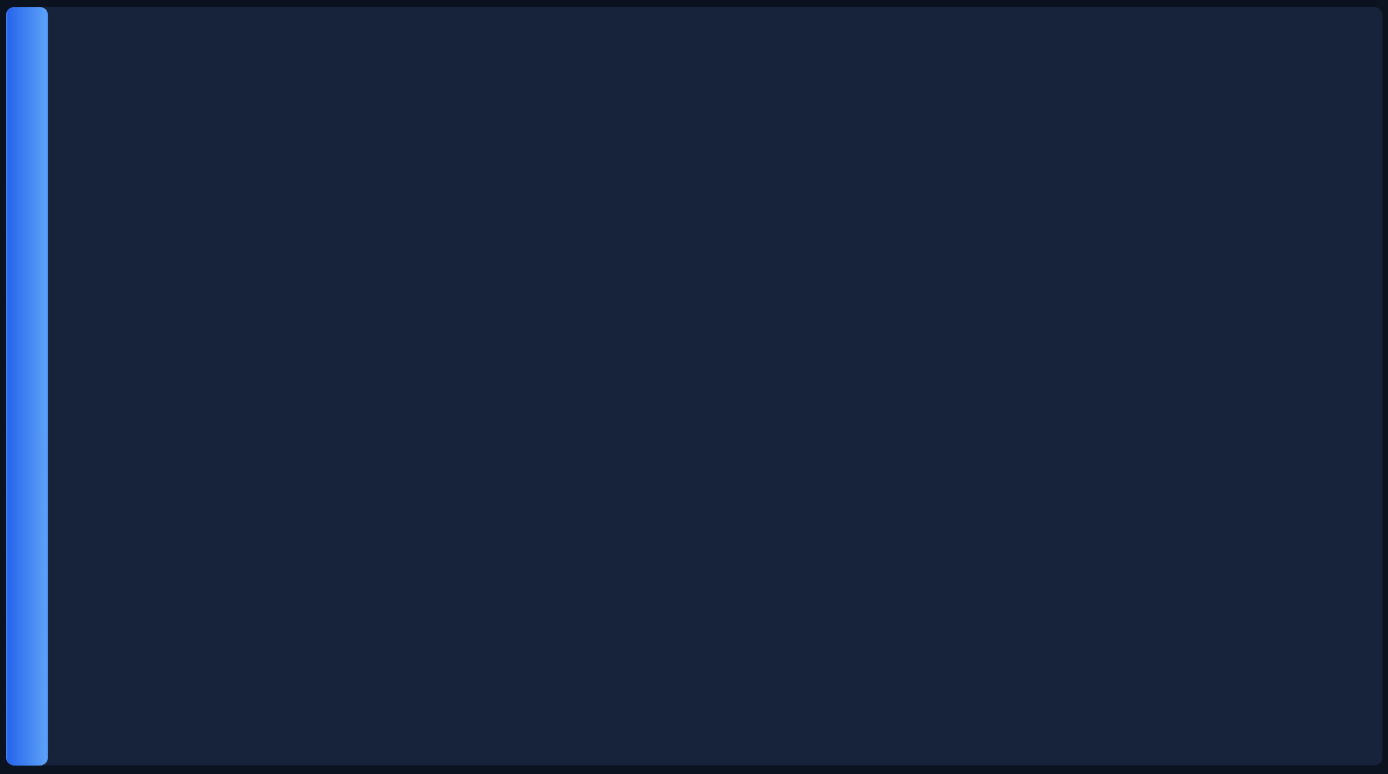
4	229	160	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

35 Dradis CE

github.com/dradis/dradis-ce

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 843	GITHUB STARS
230	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Ruby	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Dradis Framework: Collaboration and reporting for IT Security teams"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

collaborative pentest reporting: team notes, evidence and findings assembled into one professional report.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentest teams assembling reports from tool output; the free edition of the commercial reporting platform.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



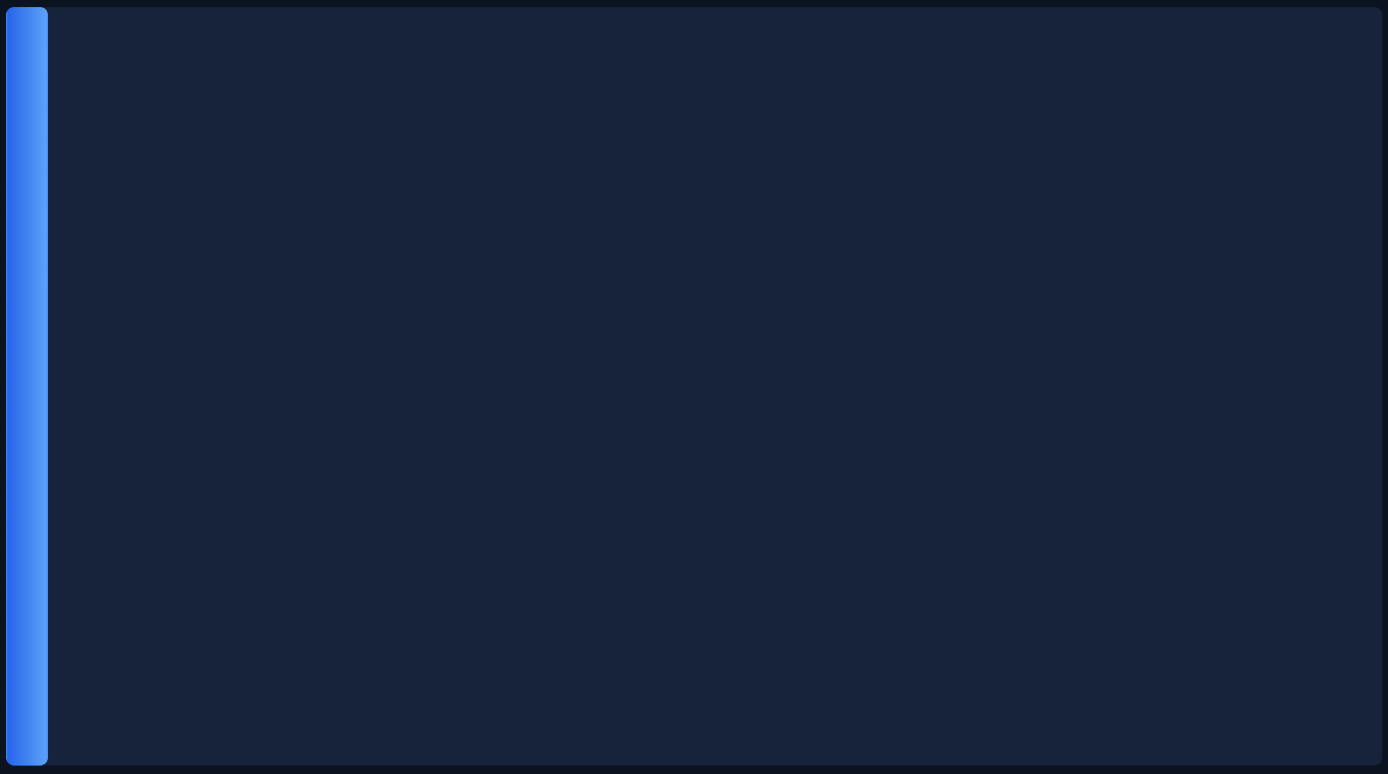
10	230	35	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

36 Hachoir

github.com/vstinner/hachoir

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 672	GITHUB STARS
72	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Hachoir is a Python library to view and edit a binary stream field by field"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

binary field inspection: split any file into its fields, even damaged ones.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by researchers extracting metadata from damaged binaries; the free Python metadata extractor.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



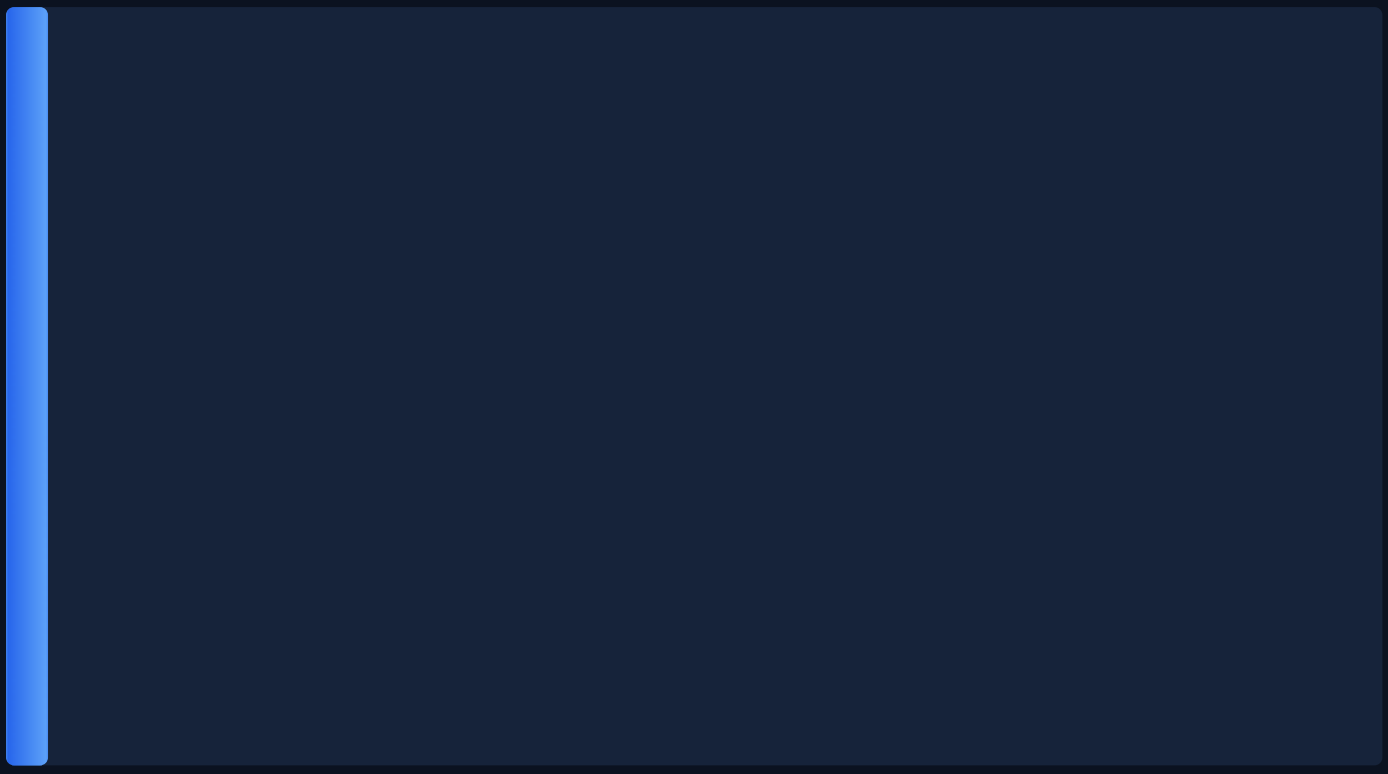
10	72	7	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

37 friTap

github.com/fkie-cad/friTap

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 556	GITHUB STARS
51	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2021	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Simplifying encrypted traffic analysis for researchers by making protocol decryption effortless."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

intercept TLS keys in real time for analysis; a Frida script for the lab.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by traffic analysts extracting TLS keys from apps via Frida; the free tool for decrypting stubborn mobile traffic.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

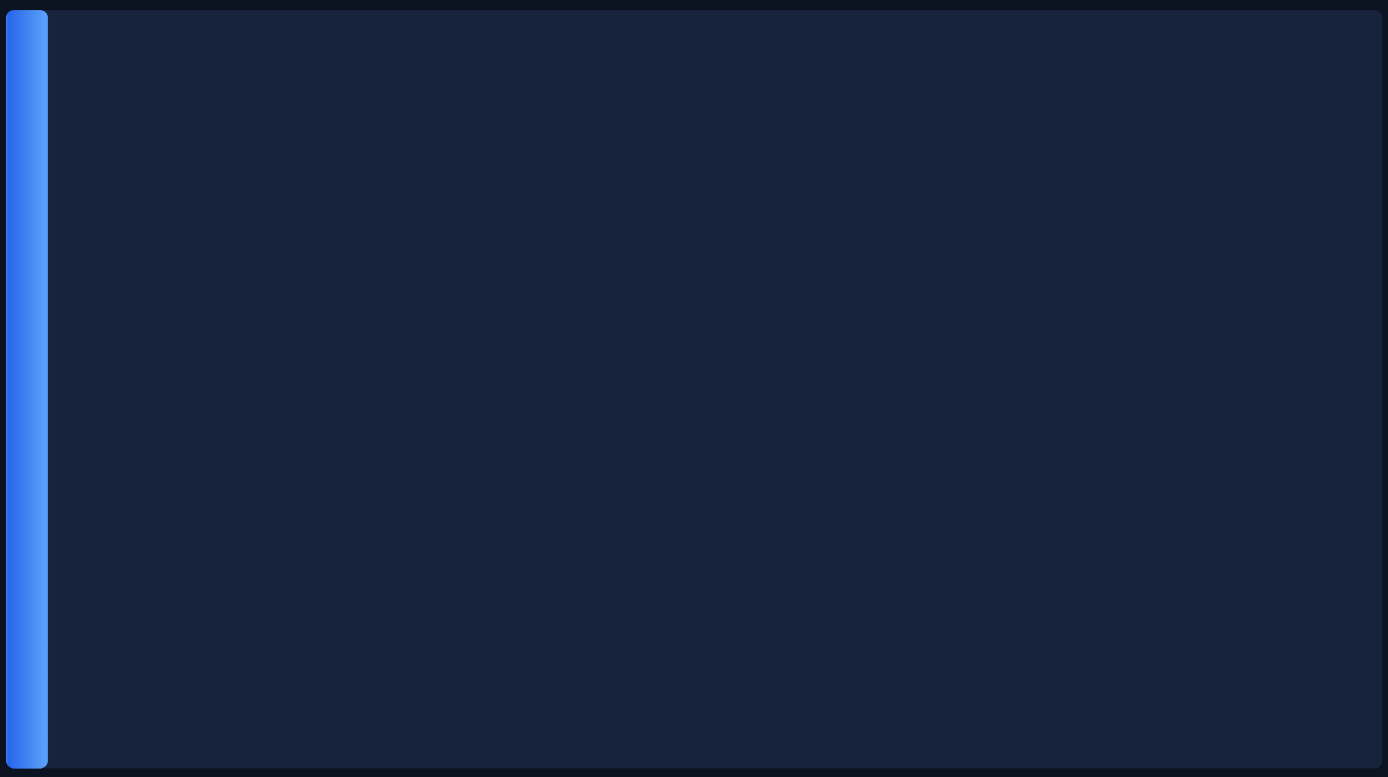


5	51	8	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

38 boxxy

github.com/kpcyrd/boxxy-rs

star weight vs realm #1



★ 85	GITHUB STARS
9	FORKS
2025-01	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
LGPL-3.0	LICENSE
Rust	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Linkable sandbox explorer"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

a rules-based sandbox for misbehaving programs; redirects what they touch.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by researchers sandboxing file operations at the syscall layer; the free isolation tool for dynamic analysis.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



9	9	10	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

39 angr

angr.io/

WEB / STANDALONE



—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“angr”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the binary-analysis platform from UCSB's Shellphish: symbolic execution at scale.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by researchers and CTF players symbolically executing binaries; the free platform for program analysis research.

40 Evan's Debugger

http://www.codef00.com/projects#debugger

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Evan's Debugger”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the C/C++ debugger with a RE focus: memory views built for analysis.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by RE practitioners debugging Linux binaries in a GUI; the free Qt-based debugger.

41 Hex Fiend

http://ridiculousfish.com/hexfiend/

WEB / STANDALONE



—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Hex Fiend"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the fast, open-source hex editor for macOS.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by macOS researchers editing binaries fast.

42 I2P

geti2p.net/

WEB / STANDALONE



—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"I2P"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Invisible Internet Project: anonymous, self-organizing overlay network.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by privacy-focused users running encrypted overlay networking; the free Invisible Internet Project with no commercial counterpart. (multiple open licenses)

43 netcat

http://nc110.sourceforge.io/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“netcat”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the original TCP/IP Swiss army knife: reads and writes across networks with one command.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by everyone from sysadmins to CTF players for raw TCP/UDP plumbing.

44 socat

http://www.dest-unreach.org/socat/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“socat”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the relay for bidirectional data transfer between addresses: TCP, UDP, sockets, pipes.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by sysadmins and pentesters relaying and shaping network connections; the netcat successor for serious plumbing.

45 Tails

tails.boum.org/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Tails"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the amnesic incognito live system: no trace left on the machine.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by journalists needing amnesic, compartmentalized computing; the free live system that leaves no trace.

46 tcpdump

www.tcpdump.org

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“tcpdump”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the command-line packet capture classic; quick looks and long captures where Wireshark won't fit.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by admins capturing packets on servers without GUIs; the classic free CLI sniffer preinstalled everywhere.

47 Wireshark

www.wireshark.org

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Wireshark”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the packet analyzer everyone knows; deep protocol visibility for troubleshooting and forensics.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by network engineers and DFIR analysts everywhere; the standard free packet analyzer commercial tools still get compared to.

04 Realm Directory

47 curated entries · A–Z

angr
Apktool
ATT&CK Navigator
Awesome Malware Analysis
binwalk
boofuzz
boxxy
Brida
Capstone
Ciphey
Cutter
CyberChef
Dangerzone
Detect It Easy
dnSpyEx
Dradis CE
Evan's Debugger
ExifTool
Faraday
Frida
friTap
Ghidra
GnuPG
Hachoir
Hex Fiend
I2P
ImHex
Interactsh
jadx
Kaitai Struct
mitmproxy
netcat
Netron
OCSF
OpenSSL
pwndbg
pyWhat
radare2
Scapy
socat
Tails
tcpdump
tcpreplay
UEFITool
Voltron
Wireshark
x64dbg